made it clear that, quite apart from the Round Table Conference and the political issues, it might be necessary for the Congress to protect the people's, and especially the peasantry's, rights in economic struggles. He had no desire to

---

Delhi Pact. But if the Government of India and Local Governments are not prepared to grant an inquiry, my colleagues and I have no objection to the clause remaining. The result will be that, whilst the Congress will not press for an inquiry in regard to 'the other matters hitherto raised' on its behalf, if unfortunately any grievance is so acutely felt that it becomes the paramount duty of the Congress to seek some method of relief, in the absence of an inquiry, in the shape of defensive direct action, the Congress should be held free to adopt such remedy, notwithstanding the suspension of civil disobedience.

"I need hardly assure the Government that it would be the constant endeavour of the Congress to avoid direct action and to gain relief by discussion, persuasion, and the like. The statement of the Congress position given here has become necessary in order to avoid any possible misunderstanding in the future or a charge of breach of faith on the part of the Congress. In the event of a successful issue to the present discussions, I assume that the *communiqué*, this letter, and your reply would be simultaneously published.

"Yours sincerely,
"M. K. GANDHI."

Mr. Emerson to Mr. Gandhi.

Simla,
August 27, 1931.

"DEAR MR. GANDHI,

"I write to thank you for your letter of to-day's date, in which you accept the draft *communiqué*, subject to the observations contained in your letter. The Governor-General-in-Council has noted that it is not the intention of the Congress to press for any inquiry into those matters hitherto raised by them, but that while you give an assurance that it will be the constant endeavour of the Congress to avoid direct action, and to gain relief by discussion, persuasion, and the like, you wish to make clear the position of the Congress in regard to any future action that they may decide to take. I am to say that the Governor-General-in-Council shares your hope that no resort to direct action will be taken. In regard to the general position of Government, I am to refer you to the letter of His Excellency the Viceroy dated August 19 to your address. I am to say that the *communiqué*, your letter of to-day's date, and this reply will be published simultaneously by Government.

"Yours sincerely,
"H. W. EMERSON."